

GIF and JPG files, play MIDI sound files and streaming audio files without the assistance of other applications. For Web programmers, though it was a different story altogether, since IE3 allowed for a choice of scripting languages and also Cascading Style Sheets (CSS).

Moving onwards, Internet Explorer 4 made its debut in 1997 and was designed for Windows 95, Windows 98, and Windows NT. Another major add-on to the release of IE4 was Outlook Express, which would be installed in the default installation and was an upgrade from the previous Internet Mail and News application. This was the first offering from Microsoft to compete with Netscape Communicator in terms of a mail client being installed with a browser.

This was also a major release for Web programmers since the introduction of DHTML as a scripting language in IE4, Web pages could be designed more dynamically. Users could now expand menus with a click or drag images and objects around on a Web page. The Web started to look more like the applications and games that people were accustomed to and less like a static series of pages.

In September 1998, Internet Explorer 5 was released. DHTML functionality was improved with more features and with emerging Web commerce ideas.

Internet Explorer 6 was first released in 2001 with the release of Windows XP operating system. Later on, IE 6 was released for other Windows flavours. One of the major improvements in IE6 was the implementation of privacy and security functionality of the browser. Since privacy and security had become customer priorities, Microsoft implemented tools that support Platform for Privacy Preferences (P3P), a technology under development by the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C).